

Question:

A mental health volunteer is interviewing locals as part of a community outreach program. A 46-year-old man discloses that he has felt sad for as long as he can remember. He feels as though his life is cursed and if something terrible can happen to him, it usually will. He has difficulty making decisions and feels hopeless. He also feels that he has had worsening suicidal ideations, guilt from past problems, energy, and concentration over the past 2 weeks. He is otherwise getting enough sleep and able to hold a job. Which of the following statement best describes this patient's condition?

Answer Choices:

- A. The patient is at risk for double depression.
- B. The patient may have symptoms of mania or psychosis.
- C. The patient is likely to show anhedonia.
- D. The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder.

Reasoning + Answer:

<think> The patient's symptoms of feelings of worthlessness , guilt , hopelessness , loss of energy , difficulty making decisions , and worsening suicidal ideations over the past 2 weeks may be indicative of major depressive disorder , a condition often referred to as " double depression ." Double depression is characterized by having episodes of major depressive disorder intertwined with dysthymia , which is a low -grade depressive disorder that is persistent </think><answer> A . The patient is at risk for double depression .

